

Safeguarding Policy

Child Welfare & Protection — Glen Villa Juniors FC

Season: 2025/26
Issued by: Glen Villa Juniors FC
Version: 1.0

1. Introduction

Glen Villa Juniors FC is committed to the highest standards of safeguarding and to ensuring the welfare of every child and young person in our care. This policy applies to all staff, volunteers, coaches, and anyone working with young people on behalf of the club.

This policy has been adopted in line with the Football Association (FA) Safeguarding Policy and the Children Act 1989 and 2004.

2. Our Commitment

Glen Villa Juniors FC is committed to:

- The welfare of children being paramount at all times.
- Ensuring all children, regardless of age, disability, gender, ethnicity, religion, or background, have the right to be protected from abuse.
- Taking all concerns and allegations seriously and responding swiftly and appropriately.
- Working in partnership with the FA, statutory agencies, parents, and carers to promote the welfare of children.
- Providing a safe and welcoming environment where children can enjoy football.

3. Club Welfare Officer

The club has a designated Club Welfare Officer (CWO) who is the first point of contact for all safeguarding concerns. The CWO has been trained in line with FA requirements and holds a valid DBS check.

All concerns regarding the welfare of a child should be reported to the Club Welfare Officer immediately. If the CWO is unavailable, concerns should be referred directly to the County FA Welfare Officer or the NSPCC Helpline (0808 800 5000).

4. Recognising Abuse

Abuse can take many forms. All club members should be aware of the following types:

- Physical abuse — causing physical harm to a child.
- Emotional abuse — persistent emotional ill-treatment causing severe or persistent adverse effects on a child's emotional development.
- Sexual abuse — involving a child in sexual activity they do not fully understand or consent to.
- Neglect — persistent failure to meet a child's basic physical or psychological needs.

If you are concerned about a child's welfare, do not ignore it. Report it to the Club Welfare Officer.

5. Reporting Concerns

Any person who has concerns about a child's welfare must report them immediately to the Club Welfare Officer.

Reports should include:

- What the child said or what was observed.
- The date, time, and location of the incident or disclosure.
- The names of any witnesses.

Do not attempt to investigate concerns yourself. Do not promise confidentiality to a child — you may be required to share information with statutory agencies.

6. Safe Recruitment

Glen Villa Juniors FC follows FA guidelines for safe recruitment. All coaches and volunteers working with children must:

- Hold a valid Enhanced DBS (Disclosure and Barring Service) check.
- Have completed FA Safeguarding Children training.
- Have provided satisfactory references.

7. Photography & Social Media

The club follows FA guidelines on the use of photography and social media. Parents and spectators wishing to photograph or film at club events must obtain permission from the club. Images of young players must not be shared publicly without appropriate consent.

8. Review

This policy will be reviewed annually or following any safeguarding incident. All club members will be made aware of updates to this policy.